

Handout 1.22: Careers Card Sort

Name: _____ Date: _____ Partner: _____

The ten cards (cut apart, one set per pair)

Pay ranges are yearly, for the New York area. Your teacher checks them against the Bureau of Labor Statistics and the NYS Department of Labor before you use them for real decisions.

Career	Education needed	A day in the life	Pay range	Cluster
Dishwasher	None past high school. Trained on the job in a day. Some start at 14 with working papers.	Runs the dish machine, scrubs pots, keeps the line stocked with clean pans, mops at close. On your feet, wet, fast. The kitchen stops if you stop.	\$28,000 to \$34,000	Hospitality and Tourism
Prep cook	None past high school. Trained on the job.	Arrives before the cooks. Washes, peels, chops, portions, and labels everything the line will need. Reads the prep list, checks dates, rotates the walk-in (FIFO).	\$30,000 to \$38,000	Hospitality and Tourism
Line cook	High school. A culinary certificate helps but many learn on the line.	Works one station (grill, saute, fry, salad) during service. Reads tickets, times every plate, keeps the station clean and stocked. Hot, loud, fast	\$33,000 to \$42,000	Hospitality and Tourism

		for four hours straight.		
Baker	High school plus a certificate or an apprenticeship.	Starts at 3 or 4 in the morning. Measures by weight, mixes, proofs, bakes, and decorates. Same recipes every day, done exactly. Quiet kitchen, early finish.	\$32,000 to \$45,000	Hospitality and Tourism
Restaurant manager	High school plus years of experience, or a two-year degree in hospitality.	Schedules the staff, orders the food, checks the books, handles the customer who is unhappy, covers a station when someone calls out. Nights and weekends.	\$50,000 to \$75,000	Hospitality and Tourism
Caterer or personal chef (owns the business)	A certificate or a culinary degree plus business skills. A food handler's permit and a business license.	Plans menus with clients, shops, cooks in other people's kitchens or a rented one, prices every job to make a profit, does the books at night. No two days the same.	\$40,000 to \$80,000, varies with the business	Hospitality and Tourism
School food service director	A four-year degree, often in nutrition or food service management.	Plans menus for hundreds of students that meet federal rules, manages the cafeteria staff and the budget, orders	\$60,000 to \$90,000	Hospitality and Tourism; Education and Training

		from vendors, handles allergies and special diets, reports to the district.		
Registered dietitian	A graduate degree in nutrition, a supervised practice program, a national exam, and New York State certification.	Meets with patients or clients in a hospital, a clinic, a school, or a sports team. Reads lab results, plans diets for medical conditions, teaches. More talking and reading than cooking.	\$65,000 to \$85,000	Health Science
Food scientist	A four-year degree in food science or chemistry; many have a master's.	Works in a lab or a factory. Tests why a product spoils, how to make it safer or last longer, what happens to a nutrient when it is cooked. Runs experiments, writes reports.	\$70,000 to \$100,000	Agriculture, Food, and Natural Resources; Science, Technology, Engineering, and Mathematics
Health inspector (food safety)	A four-year degree in a science plus a state exam.	Visits restaurants, school cafeterias, and stores without warning. Checks refrigerator temperatures, hand sinks, dates, and cross	\$55,000 to \$75,000	Health Science; Government and Public Administration

		contamination. Writes the report that can close a kitchen.		
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Sorting mat

Sort 1: By education needed. Write each career under the group it fits. Then, for each group, name one job where you did a piece of the work in this unit.

A: None past high school	B: A certificate, an apprenticeship, or a two-year degree	C: A four-year degree or more
A piece I did in this unit:	A piece I did in this unit:	A piece I did in this unit:

Sort 2: What do they mostly work with? Write each career in one column. Write one reason on the line for the hardest one to place.

Mostly food and equipment	Mostly people	Mostly data and reports

Hardest to place: _____ because _____

Sort 3: By pay. Put the ten careers in order from lowest to highest starting pay. Then circle the one that surprised you.

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____ 4. _____ 5. _____
 6. _____ 7. _____ 8. _____ 9. _____ 10. _____

“Would I like this?” self-check (individual)

Pick two careers from the cards.

	Career 1: _____	Career 2: _____
The day in the life I would rather have	[]	[]
The education I am willing to do	[] yes [] no [] maybe	[] yes [] no [] maybe
The pay would be enough for the life I want	[] yes [] no [] not sure	[] yes [] no [] not sure
Something from this unit I would use on day one		

I would / would not (circle one) like to be a _____ because _____.

Sentence starter: "I would like _____ because I like to _____. I would not like _____ because _____."

Keep this sheet in your FACS folder. It comes back in Unit 2 (who I am) and Unit 7 (careers).